

Patterns in Play — Module 05: Action — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. Why is it important to take turns in a game? (It gives everyone a chance to be the agent).
2. What is the difference between building up and knocking down? (Both are actions, but they have different effects!).
3. Why does it feel so satisfying to stack blocks really high? (Your motor prediction was right — the tower stands!).
4. How does your body learn a new physical game (like jumping rope)? (Practice, trial, error, repeat).
5. What happens when you try too hard in a game? (Tension! Sometimes relaxing helps more).
6. Why do some actions need to be fast and some need to be slow?
7. What is the most impressive physical thing you can do? Show everyone!
8. How is throwing a ball like making a prediction? (Your brain predicts the arc before your hand releases).
9. Why is cleanup part of the game? (Returning the system to its starting state!).
10. What sport or physical game would you like to get better at?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Have a "Building Challenge": Each person gets the same number of blocks. Build the tallest tower in 2 minutes. Whose stands the longest? What made the difference?
2. Set up a target (a bucket or mark on the wall). Throw a soft ball ten times. Record your hits. Your motor prediction improves with each throw!
3. Play "Obstacle Course": Design a course through the house. Time each family member. Then rearrange it and try again. How does your body adapt to new challenges?
4. Practice catching a ball. Start close, then move farther apart. At what distance does catching become hard? Your motor prediction has a range!

5. Build something with Legos or blocks WITHOUT instructions. Then build something WITH instructions. Which was harder? Which was more creative?
6. Play "Turn-Taking Tower" (like Jenga): Each person removes one piece on their turn. The game teaches patience, precision, and the consequences of action.
7. Have a dance party! Put on music and move. Notice how your body predicts the rhythm and moves along with it. Your motor system is syncing with the music.
8. Try to do 10 jumping jacks in perfect synchrony with a family member. How hard is it to match someone else's actions exactly?
9. Clean up after play together. Time the cleanup and try to beat your record. Cleanup is an action that resets the system for next time!
10. At the end of play, ask: What was the best action you took today? What action do you want to practice more? Write it down as a goal.